

Eink Phone Review

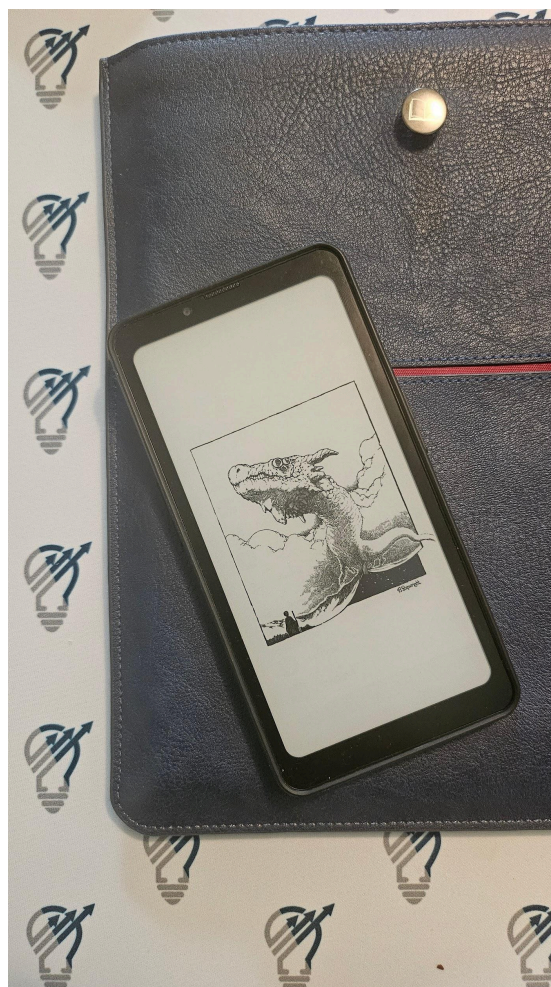
The BigMe HiBreak Pro - Is it a fad or a legitimate daily driver?

What is this phone

At its core the BigMe HiBreak Pro is an Android phone with a high refresh rate eink display. While the specs are mostly irrelevant due to the nature of its display as a bit of foreshadowing I do want to highlight its MediaTek chip since it'll eventually become a major pain point when daily driving this phone.

Why I got the phone

In early February 2026 a relative asked if I wanted anything overseas in east Asia. While I initially toyed with the idea of buying computer parts the silicon craze has hit the entire world so I eventually started thinking of weird tech that I currently don't have. At some point I remembered about eink phones and thought it would be a fun detox experience since I've had days where I lost WAY too many hours scrolling on either Instagram or Youtube. With the help of Google Gemini I quickly pathed out all my options including their pros, cons, and special notes. While I don't quite remember why I picked this particular phone, it eventually arrived sometime that month.



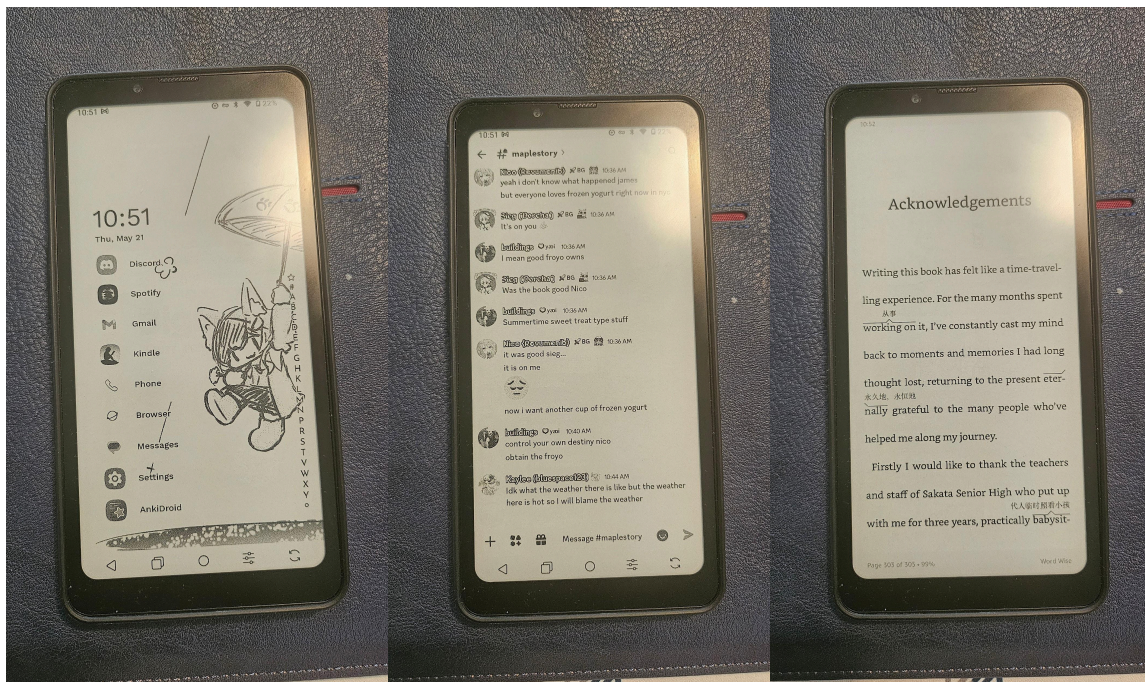
Initial Impressions

It was way larger than I would've hoped since it had the same dimensions as an iPhone 16 Pro but with a smaller screen due to eink limitations. Physical impressions aside, my second impression was the phone part itself; since I was using a US eSIM, I had to do some fun workarounds to get everything running smoothly. For context ever since 2020 most US carriers don't go out of their way to support Chinese phone bands but luckily there was ONE wavelength that overlapped between my phone plan and the BigMe

phone. So once I confirmed that I could text, call, and browse on the go I had to address the eSIM to SIM conversion since Chinese phones don't support eSIM at all. To complete the ultimate bridge I bought a SIM card that can install eSIM profiles onto it and after a bit of finagling I got everything to work!

SO! After all of that, what was my REAL first impression? The first few days were VERY fun as I got to use Android again but with a fun twist with an eink display. Then from there I set up my Kindle with the hope that I'd read more and brainrot less.

Three Months In



Some screenshots including Discord Light Mode!!!

Fast forward to May 2026 and I had finished 2 books solely on the phone and I even played around with flashcards (via Anki). Phone usage dropped to under an hour a day, and everything was great right?

No.

While it WAS effective in being a brainrot detox device, it came at quite a few costs. Some of the smaller gripes I have are the camera, the app support, and dropping cellular occasionally. While I could tolerate those, the dealbreaker was an app called DuraSpeed. Duraspeed is an AWFUL application baked into the firmware which turbo ultra mega super aggressively closes ANY app that it thinks is eating up too many resources - all in the name of better battery life. So when my Spotify randomly stops or

my Android Auto implodes I have to check my phone and YEP! Duraspeed in its infinite wisdom has decided to kill those apps. Thanks a lot.

All of this combined with the general anti-quality-of-life features (no color, poor refresh rate, slow hardware) eventually forced me to bring two phones when I'm out of the city. While I probably COULD have gotten away with just the BigMe I wasn't really thrilled at the thought of being stranded because of a small quirk popping up in the final hour. So while other folks bring their work phone around to be available 24/7, I was bringing my work phone around to provide eTickets and a constant connection to my car while I GPS to-and-from Austin.

Current Day

If you've seen my phone today you'd notice it is NOT the BigMe phone and that's because I cannot live with constant interruptions to my music. In addition, having Android Auto that actually works is nice when I'm driving regularly...

The actual switchover was VERY fast since the virtual (or in this case physical) eSIM let me just pop the phone number into the ZFlip 5 ASAP. Then from the newfound familiarity with Android I was able to quickly get up to speed with my Android launcher, apps, etc. While I always COULD go back if the brainrot gets too bad, my recent visit to New York reinforced the concept that I should probably just uninstall the problematic apps instead of rocking an eink phone.

Is there anything I really miss from the BigMe phone? Honestly just the battery life but that's more of a result of me using my ZFlip 5 for things outside of the Kindle and Phone apps.